

Weekly Writing - Week 1

Nicholas Schwab

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1. Is it more satisfying to be proficient in R or have ChatGPT handle most coding and concentrate more on the conceptual side of the material?

I would say that I would rather be proficient in R and have a balance between the conceptual/theory side and the coding side, rather than offloading most of the coding tasks to AI. While I think that AI is fine for completing or speeding up basic tasks, I also think that there is value in learning the coding skills yourself. I think that when doing statistical programming with languages like R, you are also tangentially learning statistical concepts as you learn to program with that language. For example, when I was taking PLS202, we used the `t.test` function for hypothesis testing and as we were talking about using that function, we were also reviewing the statistical theory for hypothesis testing as well as talking about what certain things mean, like μ , t-values, and how to interpret the outputs of the test.

As an aside, I think that relying too much on AI reduces your value as a worker. If you're not really familiar with any of the statistical underpinnings of what you're doing, then why does a company need to hire you to do that job if the AI you're using is more proficient and knowledgeable than you are? I think the better approach would be to use AI to assist you in your tasks, rather than relying on it to do your tasks for you. It may also happen that there are contextual elements that you are aware of that the AI is not, and therefore the interpretation of the data analysis that the AI gives you may not be as nuanced as the interpretation you give, providing of course that you are sufficiently knowledgeable in data analytics and can give reasonable interpretations.